

Tobias Treppmann

Fifteen years building for people who never chose the software, and a decade coaching adults

LOCATION Berlin, Germany

EMAIL hello@treppmann.design

PORTFOLIO treppmann.design/for/sharpist

LINKEDIN linkedin.com/in/tobiastreppmann

PROFILE

Product manager and product owner for the Bibel TV redesign, and Head of Product Design there. Before it I held product management for the main platform at ChurchDesk and ran product and design together at Ninox. Most of my fifteen years have gone to people who never chose the software they use: funeral directors, parish assistants, analysts inside regulated banks. Alongside that, a decade mentoring and coaching designers. I build in real code, and I designed the multi-agent quality architecture that decides whether generated text is good enough to keep — including removing my own reference set when it turned out to be hiding failures.

PM + PO today

leading the Bibel TV redesign alongside product design

A decade coaching

designers through CareerFoundry and the Interaction Design Foundation

EXPERIENCE

Head of Product Design · Product Manager and Product Owner, redesign

2025 – Present

Bibel TV (broadcaster in linear-to-streaming transformation — iOS, Android, web and connected TV) Hamburg + Berlin, Germany

- I am the product manager and product owner for the redesign, which is the purpose of the engagement. Design, product and ownership on one initiative.
- Multi-surface roadmap across iOS, Android, web and connected TV.
- Solving activation and retention challenges is what I am on now, with a track record of finding why people stop coming back across three companies.
- Investigating why people stop coming back. A licensed series drew a large audience; the license expired, usage fell and never recovered.
- That told us retention was being carried by the content rather than by the interface. Not a comfortable finding for a design team.
- First-session bounce is the current question, read against the paid-ad conversion funnel and what people do in their first minutes.
- Shipped an AI support copilot into production, where a mistake reaches a viewer. A Microsoft Copilot agent on a system prompt I wrote.
- It is grounded on a handbook summary page I author and structure, with a restricted-topic list and a scope rule that refuses to draft when the input is not a viewer enquiry.
- Adoption was earned, not mandated. Optional, encouraged by team leads, a self-test week, then one-to-ones. The skeptics came round after their hardest case.
- Every send stays human. That was a design decision before it was a safety one.
- Built an AI fundraising system end to end — analysis, prompt architecture, prototype, and a production Claude skill.
- Prototype in production code against real APIs. An external engineering agency ships from that code, so the handoff crosses a company boundary.
- Design system as an API — DTCG tokens in four tiers serving every surface from one source, with checks that refuse off-system work before review.
- Claude Code is the daily tool and has been for over a year.
- Built the competitive positioning argument for a German broadcaster against global entrants, on local content rather than scale.

Founder · Aperto

2025 – Present

Aperto (aperto.bible) — open Bible translation tooling and a multilingual content pipeline Berlin, Germany · independent

- Designed a multi-agent quality architecture for generated text. Nine criteria, each judged in its own model call with no shared context, plus around eleven specialized critics.
- Binary verdicts rather than scores, and any single failure rejects the draft. Partial credit hides the failure you need to see.
- No golden set, and that was a decision. I built one and removed it in July after finding it had hidden eight of eleven failures on a chapter it passed.
- A judge-drift control re-judges flagged criteria against a calibration anchor, because a judge that moves is worse than a judge that is wrong.
- Judge reasons go back to the generator verbatim, inside a loop that revises the failing span rather than re-rolling the draft.
- Designed and directed by me. Implemented with AI coding agents.

Head of Platform and Design

2024 – 2025

ChurchDesk (vertical ERP for churches and dioceses — DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH) Copenhagen, Denmark · Remote from Berlin

- Product management for the main platform, alongside leading all product design across the company.
- Wrote the specs and ran the ticket board two engineers built from. Roadmap development for the core SaaS platform.
- Reframed a customer request into a platform capability. The brief arrived as a funeral-booking feature; it shipped as booking built into the platform.
- That scoping decision ruled out the standalone module and shaped every design choice after it. One build then carried room rentals, baptisms and weddings.
- 70% less coordination time, 90% acceptance. Shipped to every customer.
- Users who had never chosen the software: funeral directors, parish assistants, priests. Almost none of these churches have anyone technical.

Head of Product Design · Interim Head of Product

2023 – 2024

Ninox Software GmbH (no-code business platform — DACH / UK / US) Berlin, Germany

- Ran product and design at the same time for four months — nine people across design, UX writing, product management and data science, on the senior leadership team.
- Three product managers and a data scientist reported to me during it.
- On the senior leadership team, advising the C-level on where the product should go and what the design function was for.
- Owned capacity, allocation, prioritization, team structure and processes for the design function.
- Developed a levelling framework covering design and UX writing, and used it for growth plans so a junior could see the path to the next level.
- Designed a lean 360 as a workshop rather than a survey, so the feedback happened in a room between the people it was about.
- Hired two, promoted two. Ran performance reviews.

- That engineer became one of the strongest contributors. Changing the conditions, not managing the person.
- That was changing the conditions rather than managing the person.
- Scaling a small team is the part I have done most. Five reports growing across two disciplines, and the culture had to survive it.
- Hiring well mattered more than hiring fast: I hired the consultant who became Head of Product permanently.

Director of Design

2016 – 2021

Datameer GmbH (data analytics for top US / CA / UK banks and insurers) · Berlin, Germany · team across Germany and NYC

- Built a research method that did not exist, screening iteratively to reach analysts inside banks and insurers who would let no vendor watch them work.
- The panels could not reach them. That was the whole problem.
- Design entered roadmap conversations and research got executive backing while the company bet on a new product for a shifting market.
- Led the design team across Germany and New York. Five years of enterprise interfaces under regulation.

EARLIER CAREER PROGRESSION

Senior Mentor · *CareerFoundry* · 2016 – 2026 · Remote · a decade mentoring and coaching designers

Mentor · *Interaction Design Foundation* · 2020 – 2022 · Remote

Product & UX Strategist · *Hypoport hub SE* · 2021 – 2022 · Berlin · Holacracy Secretary and Facilitator

UX Strategy Lead · *Spreadshirt* · 2014 – 2016 · Leipzig · inside a product triad, 200+ people

Earlier · *UX Manager, UX Designer, Web Developer* · 2009 – 2014 · Pennsylvania, USA

EDUCATION

M.A. Leadership

Kairos University, South Dakota, USA

Completed 2026

LANGUAGES

German · native

English · C2, fluent

SKILLS

Product

Product management and ownership on a live redesign · specifications, roadmaps and backlogs · scoping decisions that change what gets built · multi-surface roadmaps · prioritization and capacity across teams

Activation and retention

Churn investigated at three companies · content licensing identified as a retention driver · first-session bounce against the paid-ad funnel · success measured on outcomes rather than activity · adoption earned voluntarily rather than mandated

Applied AI

A support copilot in production · authored system prompts, restricted-topic constraints and scope suppression · grounding documents authored and structured in-house · an end-to-end AI fundraising system · Claude Code daily · prototypes in production code

People and coaching

A decade mentoring designers at CareerFoundry and the Interaction Design Foundation · M.A. Leadership · a levelling framework for design and UX writing · growth plans, performance reviews and a lean 360 run as a workshop · Holacracy Secretary and Facilitator